3/18/2026

Doctor Venkata Akshintala
Johns Hopkins University
3910 Keswick Road, N4327-B
Baltimore, MD 21211

Re: Fellowship Grant Agreement between Boston Scientific Endoscopy ("Boston Scientific") and Johns Hopkins University ("Institution")

Dear Doctor Akshintala,

This letter constitutes a Fellowship Grant Agreement ("Agreement") between Boston Scientific and Institution. The Institution's fellowship grant application describes in detail the program for which Institution seeks grant support. In awarding the Institution the fellowship grant ("Fellowship Grant Funds"), in the amount of $50,000.00, the parties agree to the following:

1. **Release of Funds:** Fellowship Grant Funds will be released in Boston Scientific's sole discretion, generally, in **two equal increments**, following Boston Scientific's timely receipt of:
   i. First Increment – an unmodified, original of this Agreement, signed by an authorized representative of Institution **within thirty (30) days of receipt of this Agreement**; and
   ii. Second Increment – fully completed Mid-Year report with supporting documentation (in the form and format of the enclosed Mid-Year Report), signed by an authorized representative of Institution by **December 1, 2026.**

2. **Purpose:** Funds provided by Boston Scientific to Institution are restricted, and may be used to support only the salary and the portion of employee benefits (*e.g.,* health, dental, vision coverage) typically supported by Institution for its employees generally in conjunction with *bona fide* Endoscopy Fellowship position(s) at Institution for the 7/1/2026 - 6/30/2027 academic year. Funds may not be used for any other purpose (*e.g.,* overhead, indirect expenses). Institution shall promptly notify Boston Scientific in writing of any proposed material changes to the fellowship program that Institution described in its grant application, including but not limited to, termination of the program, changes to the budget or size of the program, or dismissal and/or departure of any of the fellows supported by this funding. Boston Scientific may terminate this Agreement and/or payment in the event of a material breach of the terms and conditions of this Agreement, which breach is not cured within thirty (30) days of the date of the written notice of the breach from Boston Scientific, and, in such an event, Institution will immediately refund to Boston Scientific the full amount of the fellowship funds paid to Institution under this Agreement.

3. **Required Reports:** Institution shall provide Boston Scientific with **both** a (i) **Mid-Year Report** and a (ii) **Year-End Report,** using the format required by Boston Scientific, including all supporting documentation requested by Boston Scientific, which accounts for all uses of the fellowship funds provided pursuant to this Agreement. The **Mid-Year Report** is due on or before **December 1, 2026**. The **Year-End Report** is due on or before **April 1, 2027**, or ninety (90) days prior to the end of the academic year described in Section 2 above, whichever is later. Failure to timely return all required reports will be considered in the evaluation of an Institution's application as negative criteria when Boston Scientific considers whether to award any future fellowship funding to your Institution.

4. Return of Unused Funds: Institution agrees to repay or return to Boston Scientific, by or before September 1, 2027, any funds not used for the grant purposes or any funds remaining after the completion of the 2026-2027 academic year.

5. Publicity. Boston Scientific invites Institution to publicize this support through press releases and/or other appropriate avenues. Institution acknowledges that Boston Scientific must review and approve press releases and any other such materials prior to their release. Please contact Boston Scientific, endogrants@bsci.com for assistance. In any other written materials published by Institution, Institution may identify Boston Scientific as a contributor to this fellowship program. Institution acknowledges that Boston Scientific may disclose information about this fellowship support (*e.g.*, your organization's name, the purpose for which the funding was given, the amount of the funding and other basic information about this fellowship support) in tax returns, to the public and/or to various government agencies.

6. Not Excluded/Debarred. Institution warrants that Institution is not excluded, debarred, suspended, or otherwise ineligible to participate in U.S. government health care programs (e.g., Medicare, Medicaid, CHAMPUS) or U.S. government procurement and non-procurement programs (collectively, "U.S. Programs"). If during the term of this Agreement, Institution becomes excluded, debarred, suspended, or otherwise ineligible to participate in any of the U.S. Programs Institution will immediately refund to Boston Scientific the full amount of the fellowship grant.

7. Control of Fellowship and Selection of Fellows. Institution acknowledges that Institution has sole responsibility and control of the requirements, curriculum and expectations of the fellowship, and that Boston Scientific and its affiliates have no control over the requirements, curriculum or expectations of the fellowship. In addition, Institution acknowledges that Institution shall have complete control over the procedures relating to the selection of the fellow(s) and the ultimate selection of the fellow(s). Institution shall be solely responsible for conducting the fellowship program in accordance with applicable law, ethical codes and its policies and procedures, and Institution acknowledges that Boston Scientific shall not be liable in any way for any costs, damages, claims or expenses arising from Institution's fellowship program and/or any acts or omissions by Institution or the fellow.

8. Transparency. The U.S. Physician Payment Sunshine Act requires all pharmaceutical, biologics and medical device manufacturers to track and disclose to the U.S. government payments and other transfers of value paid to U.S. physicians and teaching hospitals. This includes tracking and disclosing that portion of Boston Scientific's fellowship grant used to pay U.S. physicians participating in a fellowship program. These amounts will be disclosed under each individual fellow's name. Institution will provide Boston Scientific on each of the required reports listed in Section 3 of this Agreement a list of each individual fellow receiving support through the Boston Scientific fellowship grant as well as the amount of Boston Scientific funds paid to each fellow.

9. Independence of Institution: Both parties acknowledge that the Federal Anti-Kickback Statute, 42 U.S.C. § 1320a-7b, prohibits, among other things, giving or receiving remuneration in return for (or to induce) referrals, purchases, or recommendations of goods or services for which payment may be made in whole or in part by Medicare or Medicaid. Neither the approval of Institution's fellowship grant application nor the payment of the fellowship grant described in this Agreement is conditioned in any way on the explicit or implicit requirement or expectation that Institution purchase or recommend Boston Scientific products.

Boston Scientific is proud to support fellowship training programs that help educate the next generation of physicians so that they may provide high quality, compassionate patient care.

****Signatures to follow on next page****

AGREED AND ACKNOWLEDGED:

I certify that I am authorized to enter into this Agreement on behalf of Institution and agree to all the terms of this Agreement.

Signature: _____
Date

Printed Name: _____

Title: _____

Institution Name: _____

Advanced Fellowship Venkata Akshintala

Director Signature: Venkata Akshintala

Date 5/27/26

Fellowship Title: Associate Professor

BOSTON SCIENTIFIC CORPORATION

Signature: _____
Date

Printed Name: _____

Print Title: _____

Boston Scientific Funds to be Paid to U.S. Fellow Salary and Benefits:
This section must be complete

Name of U.S. Fellow	Specialty and NPI Number (if applicable)	Contact Information	Amount of Boston Scientific Funds to be Paid to U.S Fellow

You may also submit as a separate attachment using this format.